You have to reinvest.

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📋 Executive Summary

Financial discipline — specifically building a cash nest egg inside your business rather than spending as you earn — is what separates people who survive bad periods from those who are forced out of the game entirely.

📑 Contents

🧠 The Self-Management Trap That Stops Growth 0:00

- Many people start doing well in business but struggle to reach the next level
  - The identified reason: an inability to manage themselves, not external circumstances
  - This gap can feel deeply personal — it's easy to conclude "something is wrong with me"

💰 Financial Discipline as a Survival Tool 0:00

- One of the key factors credited with surviving "the absolute worst days in business" was having financial discipline
  - Specifically: building up a **nest egg inside the business** rather than extracting and spending earnings
  - This reserve is what allows a business owner to stay in the game when conditions turn bad

> "I had the financial discipline to build up a nest egg in the business."

📱 The Social Media Spending Trap 0:17

- People who visibly spend heavily on social media as they earn are most vulnerable when things go wrong
  - When a downturn hits, they lack the financial cushion to keep operating
  - They lose the choice to stay in — even if they want to — because the money simply isn't there
  - The implication: reinvesting and saving, rather than lifestyle-spending, is what preserves optionality in hard times